



Chief Minister, Mr Bhupinder Singh Hooda inaugurates Medical College & Allied medical institutes in the backward region of Mewat.

the recruitment process of doctors. The recruitment of doctors has been taken out of the purview of the State Public Service Commission. A high-level departmental committee recruits doctors and specialists throughout the year through a web-enabled process. The transparency in the recruitment is maintained by providing all information on the department website. As a result, about 1,200 doctors have been recruited since November 2008. As many as 597 specialists like gynaecologists, paediatricians, anaesthetists and ophthalmologists have been recruited through this process.

New strides in medical education

To ensure improved supply of doctors and augment tertiary healthcare the



Free surgeries for poor

state has embarked on setting up new medical colleges.

The construction work of medical college at Khanpur Kalan, Sonapat, for girls is in full swing and expected to be completed in December 2010. Another medical college in Mewat district is being set up at a cost of Rs 700 crore. The project includes the construction of a 450-bed hospital, medical college, hostels for doctors and nursing students, besides residences for doctors and other staff.

Due to untiring efforts made by Rohtak MP Mr Deepender Singh Hooda the existing medical college at Rohtak is being upgraded to give it an AIIMS-like status under the Pradhan Mantri Swasthaya Suraksha Yojana. It is being done at a cost of Rs 150 crore. The college would soon have a centre of excellence for mental health.

This is also largely due to the efforts made by the young MP Deepender Hooda that Haryana scored a major victory over its neighbouring states when it succeeded in getting the All India Institute of Medical Sciences at Badhsa village in Jhajjar. Haryana promptly presented 300 acres of prime land for the purpose. The other healthcare institute on the anvil is the National Institute of Aging and Cancer.

Referral transport

According to Mrs Anuradha Gupta, Secretary, Health, Haryana has achieved

another first-of-its-kind initiative, by setting up a network of more than 300 ambulances to provide low-cost referral transport to people in rural areas. The ambulances will be equipped with the GPS facility. With this, people can call up a universal toll free number -- 102 -- to access the ambulance services. The services would be free for the BPL patients, pregnant women and the accident cases.

Mother and child services

The safe delivery and the care of the newborn is the priority area of the government. To improve the mother and child healthcare in the state, 350 women medical officers have been recruited; besides, trained gynaecologists are available in all the hospitals. The facility of free ante-natal check-up, safe delivery and post-natal check-up is now available in all delivery huts. The highly-skilled and experienced doctors at the government hospitals treat the caesarean cases free of cost, whereas patients have to pay at least Rs 15,000 for the treatment of such cases in private hospitals.

"Health was not getting its due attention during the last regime. For the past five years the Congress Government has focussed on healthcare. We have more medical colleges and doctors. AIIMS is setting up its second campus at Jhajjar. It will be bigger than AIIMS at Delhi. PGIMS at Rohtak has the status of a university. An all women medical college at Khanpur Kalan besides another medical college is coming up in the backward region of Mewat".

- Deepender Hooda, MP, Rohtak

An additional recruitment of 2,400 nurses at primary health centres has been done to provide a round-the-clock safe institutional delivery facility.

IMPACT

Institutional delivery has increased to 68.9 per cent in June 2009

Health education in villages

The Sakshar Mahila Samooch (SMS), a registered society of all educated women in the village, is now engaged in conducting health education. There are 6,200 SMS groups with about four lakh members. The members of the SMS have been trained to conduct health IEC activities as per a planned calendar. Easy to disseminate IEC material in Hindi has been designed to take health messages to the target population. 62,000 SMS members are now actively campaigning for better nutrition, clean environment, improved hygiene, safe drinking water and healthy lifestyle. ■